

Hazardous Earth

Atmospheric circulation = The movement of air within the Polar, Ferrel and Hadley Cells controlled by radiation from the sun.

Asthenosphere = The upper layer of Earth's mantle below the lithosphere

Lithosphere = Includes both the crust and the top layer of the upper mantle.

Conservative boundary = Convection currents cause tectonic plates to slide past each other (like in Haiti)

Convergent plate boundary = Where two plates are moving towards each other, resulting in the oceanic plate subducting e.g. Japan.

Divergent boundary = Where two plates are moving apart e.g. Iceland.

High pressure = The 'weight' of sinking air exerts more pressure on the ground and an area of high pressure is formed causing areas to become arid.

Low pressure = The warmth of the Earth's surface causes air to rise, exerting less pressure on the ground forming low pressure causing rainfall.

Enhanced greenhouse effect = The trapping of heat radiation around the Earth by excess greenhouse gases produced through human activity.

Greenhouse gases = Human activities such as energy, industry, transport and farming that produce greenhouse gases e.g. carbon dioxide and methane

Explosivity = A measure of the relative explosiveness of volcanic eruptions varying due to formation on convergent or divergent boundaries.

Tropical cyclones = Large-scale, rotating storms that form over oceans (26.5°C) in tropical areas.

Storm surges = A tropical cyclone creates a large area of low pressure, which allows the level of the sea to rise.

Warning strategies = Forecasting, monitoring and prediction that allows advance warnings for preparation and evacuation.

Development dynamics

Frank (dependency theory) = A socialist view that explains how the core (developed countries) exploit the periphery (developing countries).

Rostow (modernisation theory) = A view that suggests countries move through five stages of economic development.

Intergovernmental organisation (IGO) = A group of countries established by a treaty (like the World Bank or UN)

Nongovernmental organisation (NGO) = A private organisation, which is distinct from governmental agencies that works to make life better for the poor e.g. Oxfam.

Bottom-up = Projects that involve local people and communities in decision-making, often involving small-scale projects for the poorest.

Top-down = Where decisions are made by governments or large companies with little consultation

Multilateral aid = Aid provided by a group of countries or an institution such as the World Bank to a poor country to fund development.

Tied aid = Money that a rich country lends to a poor country on the condition that the poor country spends the money on goods and services from the rich country.

Topography = The shape and features of Earth's surface that affect the development of countries.

Site = The actual location of a settlement on the Earth, composed of the physical characteristics of the landscape.

Situation = The location of a place relative to its surroundings and other places.

Connectivity = Improved connections with the rest of the world owing to globalisation.

Globalisation = The increasing interconnectedness and interdependence of the world economically, culturally and politically.

Trans-national corporations (TNCs) = A firm that owns or controls productive operations in more than one country through foreign direct investment.

Foreign direct investment (FDI) = Overseas investment of capital by transnational companies.

Geopolitical influence = When a country becomes a major international player in the world market having established good trading relationships.

Challenges of an Urbanising World

Formal employment = Official work that is taxed with contracts and job security.

Informal employment = Unofficial work, no taxes, often 'cash-in-hand' with no contract or job security.

Planning regulations = Decisions made by the local government that determine what developments can take place when and where.

Suburbanisation = The outward spread of the built-up area.

Urbanisation = The increase in the percentage of people living in towns and cities.

Counterurbanisation = The movement of people from major cities to smaller settlements.

Natural increase = Birth rate - Death rate for a place. Normally given as % of total population.

Migration = The internal (rural-urban) and international (country to country) movement of people.

Spatial growth (patterns) = How much extra space a city takes up as it grows.

Squatter/slum settlements = Poor quality, illegal housing made from scrap materials that are often found on the outskirts of developing country cities.

Urban land-use = What land is used for.

Urban structure = The location of the central business district (CBD), high and lower quality housing, and squatter settlements within a city.